

Editorial Topic Analysis: Black Media Coverage of Social Conflict

A systematic analysis of social justice and social conflict topic coverage across seven major Black media publications over a rolling 30-day window, using TF-IDF keyword scoring and seed-phrase topic matching.

REPORT DATE

October 01, 2026

ANALYSIS WINDOW

September 01, 2026 – October 01, 2026

TOTAL ARTICLES

1423

PUBLICATIONS

9

TOPICS TRACKED

12

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Key findings from this analysis period.

TOTAL ARTICLES

1423

Across 9 publications

ARTICLES TAGGED

112

Matched ≥ 1 topic

COVERAGE RATE

7.9%

Of total corpus

MOST COVERED TOPIC

Economic Equity & We...

33 articles

Key Finding — During this period, 7.9% of articles addressed at least one tracked social conflict topic. The three most-covered topics were: Economic Equity & Wealth Gap (33), School Funding (16), Policing & Public Safety (14).

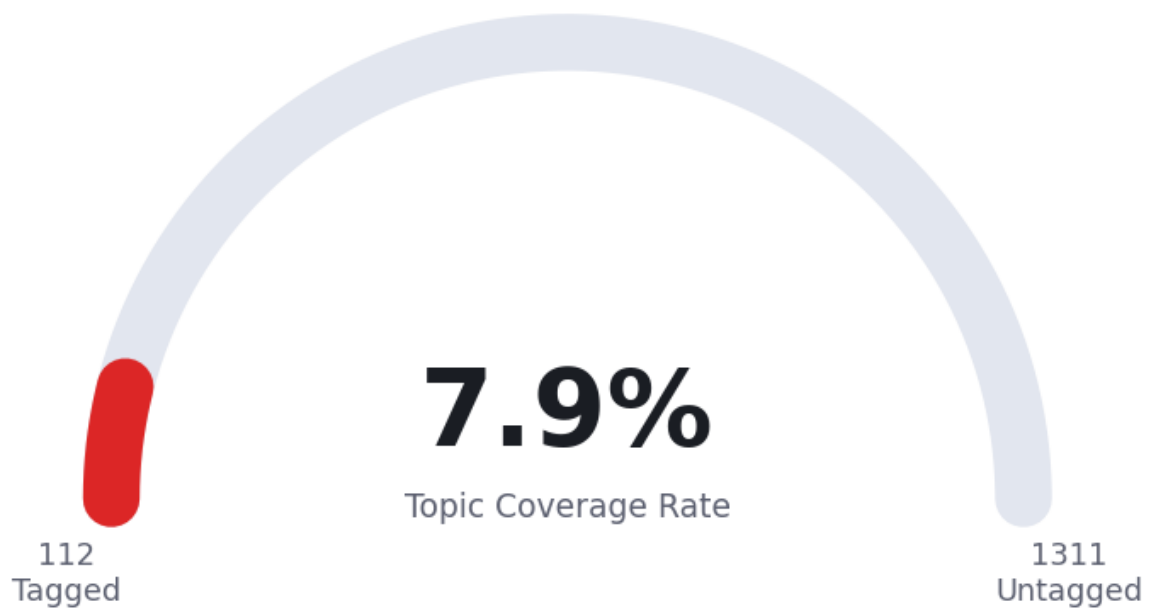


Figure 1.1 — Topic coverage rate for this reporting period

Article Distribution by Publication

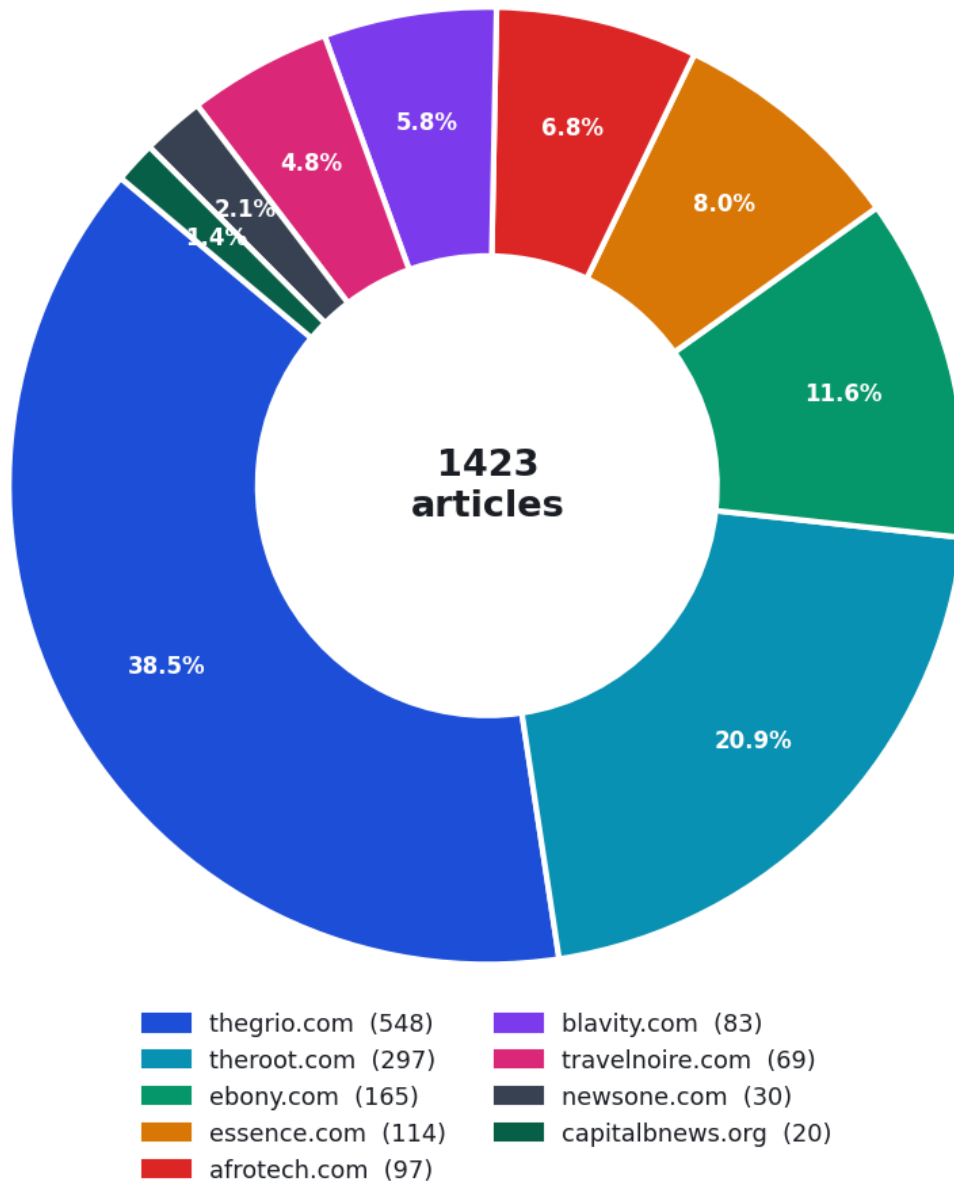


Figure 1.2 — Article distribution by publication

SECTION 02

Publication Overview

Per-publication article counts, topic coverage rates, and dominant topics for this reporting period.

PUBLICATION	ARTICLES	TOPICS COVERED	TAGGED	COVERAGE RATE	DOMINANT TOPIC
thegrio.com	548	8	29	5.3%	Economic Equity & Wealth Gap
theroot.com	297	10	30	10.1%	Economic Equity & Wealth Gap
ebony.com	165	5	6	3.6%	Economic Equity & Wealth Gap
essence.com	114	4	6	5.3%	Economic Equity & Wealth Gap
afrotech.com	97	5	12	12.4%	School Funding
blavity.com	83	9	10	12.0%	Reparations
travelnoire.com	69	1	6	8.7%	Economic Equity & Wealth Gap
newsone.com	30	4	9	30.0%	Policing & Public Safety
capitalbnews.org	20	3	4	20.0%	Voter Suppression

SECTION 03

Topic Frequency Analysis

Frequency of each social conflict topic across all publications during this period, ranked by article count.

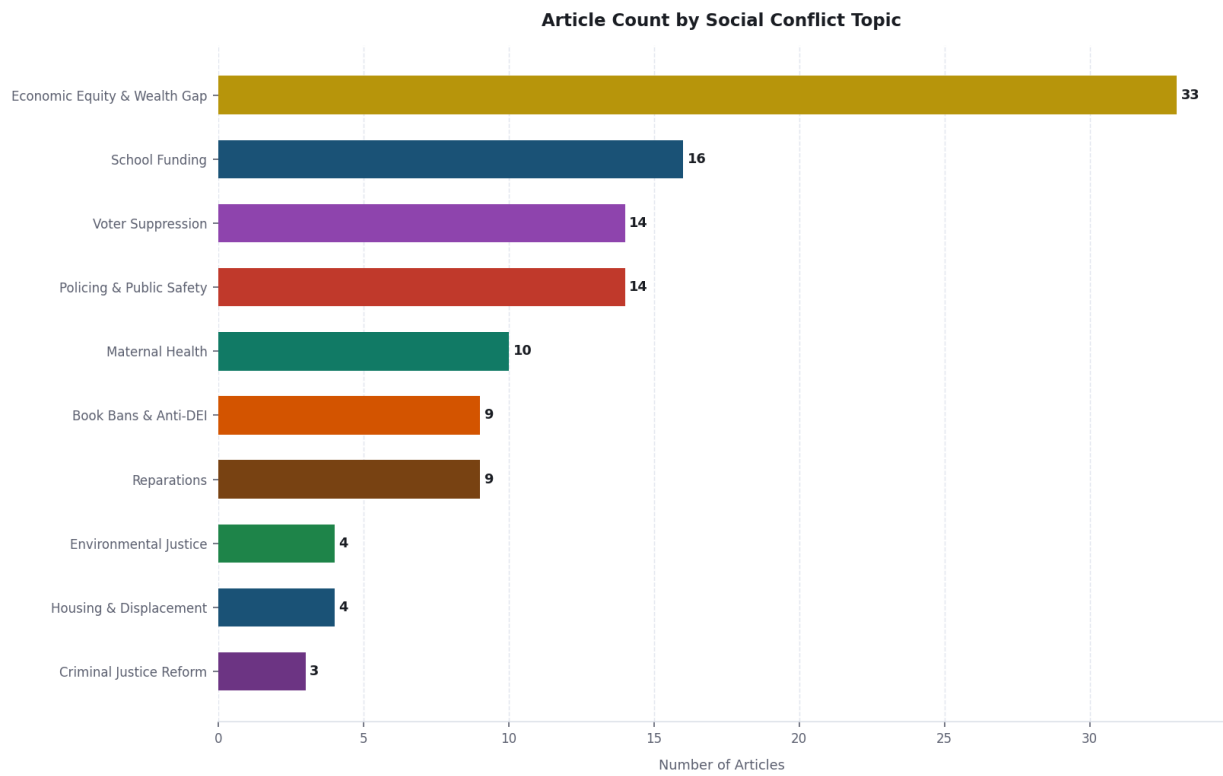


Figure 3.1 — Article count by social conflict topic (all publications)

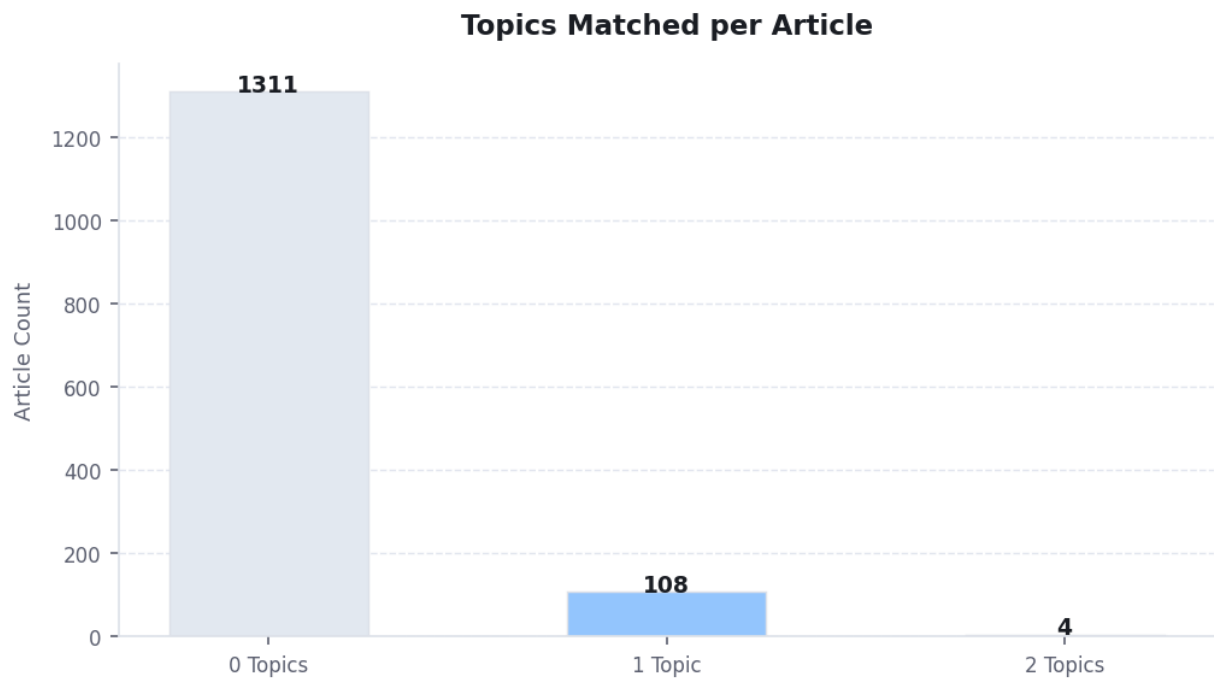


Figure 3.2 — Number of distinct topics matched per article

SECTION 04

Publication × Topic Coverage Matrix

Cross-tabulation of topic coverage by publication. Cell values represent the number of articles in which each topic was detected.



Figure 4.1 — Topic coverage heatmap (publications × topics)

SECTION 05

Publication Timeline

Daily article volume across all publications over the 30-day analysis window, with per-publication breakdowns.

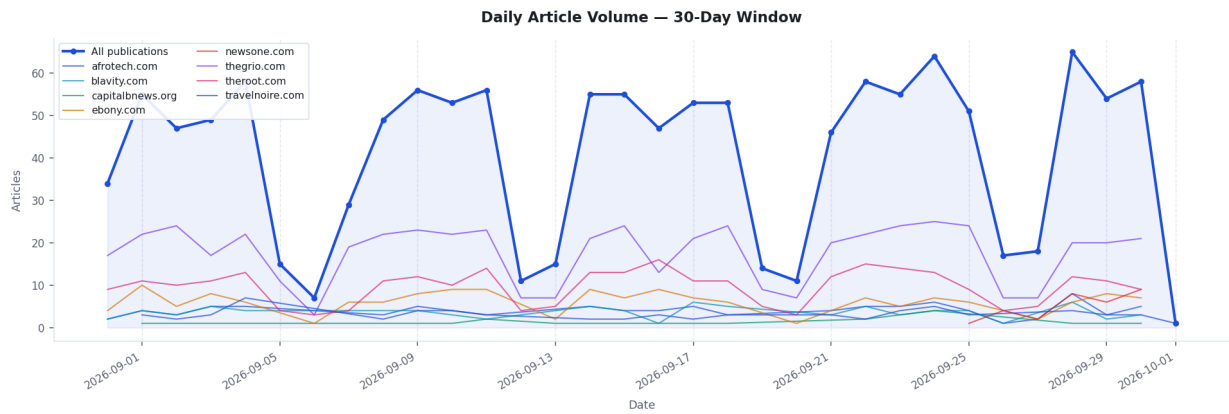


Figure 5.1 — Daily article volume by publication (September 01, 2026 – October 01, 2026)

SECTION 06

TF-IDF Keyword Analysis

Terms and phrases with the highest TF-IDF scores across the full article corpus, representing language that is distinctively prominent in this reporting period.

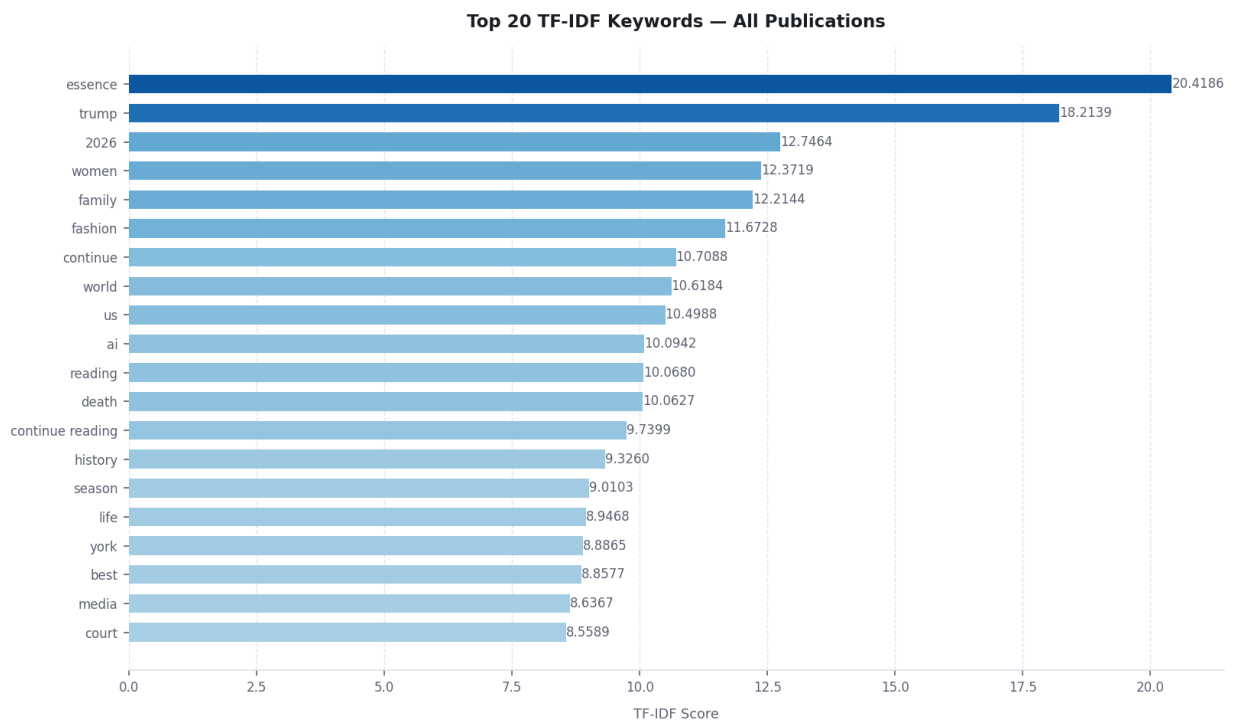


Figure 6.1 — Top 20 TF-IDF keywords (n-grams 1–3, all publications)

essence	20.4186
trump	18.2139
2026	12.7464
women	12.3719
family	12.2144
fashion	11.6728
continue	10.7088
world	10.6184
us	10.4988
ai	10.0942
reading	10.0680
death	10.0627
continue reading	9.7399
history	9.3260
season	9.0103
life	8.9468
york	8.8865
best	8.8577
media	8.6367
court	8.5589
former	8.4499
star	8.3549
old	8.2390
health	7.9148
know	7.8925
different	7.7901
million	7.5876
administration	7.4555

public	7.1711
need	7.1468

SECTION 07

Topic Deep Dive & Article Index

For each detected social conflict topic: all matched articles with title, publication, date, category, URL, and the specific phrases that triggered the match.

Economic Equity & Wealth Gap

33 articles

Racial wealth gap, Black entrepreneurship, wage discrimination, economic mobility, poverty

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Sen. Angela Alsobrooks On What Black Women Need From Washington https://www.essence.com/news/angela-alsobrooks-cbc-black-women-washington-midterms/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	News	generational wealth
By Us Beauty: The Best Black-Owned Beauty Launches From September 2026 https://www.essence.com/hair/by-us-beauty-september-2026/	ESSENCE.COM	Akili King	nan	Beauty	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
'Less Is More' Black-Owned Beauty Products To Try - Essence https://www.essence.com/video/less-is-more-black-owned-beauty-products-to-try-2025/	ESSENCE.COM	https://www.facebook.com/essence	nan	Video	black-owned
Meet the Black family behind the Luster's Pink hair lotion you grew up with https://thegrio.com/2026/09/30/meet-the-black-family-behind-the-lusters-pink-hair-lotion-you-grew-up-with/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-09-30	Business	black-owned
The Quaker Reparations That Helped This Black Philly Family Build Generational Wealth https://www.theroot.com/the-quaker-reparations-that-helped-this-black-philly-fa-2000126454	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-29	Culture	generational wealth
Trump administration moves to cut \$810 million, including funds for minority-owned businesses https://thegrio.com/2026/09/28/trump-federal-funding-cuts-810-million/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-28	Politics	minority business

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Did you spot these Black-Owned brands in Netflix's 'A Different World'? https://thegrio.com/2026/09/28/did-you-spot-these-black-owned-brands-in-netflixs-a-different-world/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-09-28	Lifestyle	black-owned
Tips for Finding the Perfect Financial Advisor to Grow and Manage Your Money https://www.ebony.com/tips-for-finding-the-perfect-financial-advisor-to-grow-and-manage-your-money/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-24	Life	generational wealth
What happened when Black women received guaranteed income? New data offers answers https://thegrio.com/2026/09/23/what-happened-when-black-women-received-guaranteed-income-new-data-offers-answers/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-09-23	Lifestyle	black bank

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Mamdani Announces Record \$131.5 Million DoorDash Settlement For NYC Delivery Workers https://blavity.com/mamdani-record-doordash-settlement-for-nyc-delivery-workers	BLAVITY.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-09-23	News	economic justice
In LA? Going On This Black-Owned Food Tour Is A Must https://travelnoire.com/daisys-black-food-tour-la	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-09-23	Culture	black-owned
New Orleans Was Just Named America's Top Foodie City, And This Black-Owned Restaurant Made The List https://travelnoire.com/top-foodie-city-new-orleans	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-09-23	Culture	black-owned
13 Trailblazing Black Americans Who Helped Shape the Labor Movement https://www.theroot.com/13-trailblazing-black-americans-who-helped-shape-the-la-2000124689	THEROOT.COM	Asheea Smith	2026-09-21	America. In Black.	economic justice

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Will Travel To Read: The First Black-Owned Bookstore On The Las Vegas Strip https://travelnoire.com/black-owned-bookstore-las-vegas	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Mitti Hicks	2026-09-21	News	black-owned
Mark Zuckerberg Doesn't Think The AI Industry Needs To Slow Down https://afrotech.com/mark-zuckerberg-doesnt-think-ai-industry-needs-to-slow-down	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-18	Technology	economic empowerment
Senator Alsobrooks wants Democrats talking generational wealth with Black voters: 'Wealth is not a dirty word' https://thegrio.com/2026/09/18/angela-alsobrooks-generational-wealth-black-voters/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-18	Politics	generational wealth black wealth
Black Culture Where You (Likely) Least Expect: Exploring Black Businesses in Edmonton, Alberta https://travelnoire.com/black-owned-edmonton-alberta-canada	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Mitti Hicks	2026-09-18	Culture	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
The gender wage gap improved in 2025, unless you're a Black woman https://thegrio.com/2026/09/18/the-gender-wage-gap-improved-in-2025-unless-youre-a-black-woman/	THEGRIO.COM	Kay Wicker	2026-09-18	Lifestyle	wage gap
The AfroTech 2026 Foodie Guide: Black-Owned Spots, Conference Vendors, And Houston's Best Tables https://travelnoire.com/where-to-eat-afrotech-houston	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Natasha Decker	2026-09-17	Plan & Shop	black-owned
22-Year-Old WNBA Player Flau'jae Johnson Buys An Additional 15 Acres After Previously Purchasing Property In 2025 — 'This Land Represents More Than Just An Inve https://afrotech.com/flaujae-johnson-purchases-additional-15-acres-of-land-for-a-commercial-property	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-16	Business	generational wealth

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
One Of Houston's Most Stunning Restaurants Is Proof You Don't Have To Dream Small https://travelnoire.com/black-owned-cocody-restaurant-houston	TRAVELNOIRE.COM	Mitti Hicks	2026-09-16	Culture	black-owned
Opinion: Black Unemployment Is America's Labor Warning Light https://www.theroot.com/opinion-black-unemployment-is-america-s-labor-warning-2000125748	THEROOT.COM	Karen Boykin-Towns	2026-09-14	News	black unemployment
Why Black-Owned Music Festivals Are Struggling in 2026 — and What Could Save Them https://www.theroot.com/why-black-owned-music-festivals-are-struggling-in-2026-2000125238	THEROOT.COM	Leon Valentine	2026-09-11	News	black-owned
From Sauce to Seasoning: The Ultimate Black-Owned BBQ Guide https://www.theroot.com/from-sauce-to-seasoning-the-ultimate-black-owned-bbq-g-2000124179	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-09-07	Culture	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Ms. Rachel's Repost Helped This Black-Owned Bakery Make Rent https://www.theroot.com/ms-rachels-repost-helped-this-black-owned-bakery-make-2000124502	THEROOT.COM	Mahalia Otshudy	2026-09-06	Business	black business black-owned
Black-owned LA bakery sees sales surge after viral boost from Ms. Rachel https://thegrio.com/2026/09/04/bomme-sweets-sales-ms-rachel-black-owned-bakery/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-04	Featured	black-owned
How This Black-Owned Business Got Its Rent Covered For A Month With The Help Of Ms. Rachel https://afrotech.com/how-this-black-owned-business-got-its-rent-covered-for-a-month-with-the-help-of-ms-rachel	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-03	Business	black business black-owned business black-owned
Is NIL Money Undermining the Fight for Black Political Power? https://www.theroot.com/is-nil-money-undermining-the-fight-for-black-political-2000124102	THEROOT.COM	Rashad Grove	2026-09-03	News	generational wealth

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
From Afrobeats to hip-hop, Afro Plus Fest is making the DMV a home for Black culture https://thegrio.com/2026/09/02/afro-plus-fest-2026-dmv-black-music-culture/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-09-02	Entertainment	black-owned
He Built His \$30 Million Brand Without Quitting His 9-to-5 https://www.theroot.com/he-built-his-30-million-brand-without-quitting-his-9-t-2000123932	THEROOT.COM	B.Kadijat Towolawi	2026-09-01	Black Business	black business
The Doux Brings Black Hair and Salon Culture to Roblox With ‘My Salon Empire’ https://www.ebony.com/the-doux-brings-black-hair-and-salon-culture-to-roblox-with-my-salon-empire/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-01	Beauty	black-owned
From Celebrity Hairstylist to Fragrance Founder, Why Kahh Spence’s Next Act Smells Like a Million Dollars https://www.theroot.com/from-celebrity-hairstylist-to-fragrance-founder-why-ka-2000123517	THEROOT.COM	Ty Cole	2026-08-31	Beauty	black-owned

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
6 Black-owned haircare brands making products for curls, coils, and every texture https://thegrio.com/2026/08/31/6-black-owned-haircare-brands-making-products-for-curls-coils-and-every-texture/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-08-31	Featured	black-owned



School Funding

16 articles

Education funding disparities, underfunded schools, school closures, Black student outcomes

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Toni Morrison's 'The Bluest Eye' Abruptly Pulled From Georgia School Libraries https://blavity.com/toni-morrison-the-bluest-eye-abruptly-pulled-from-georgia-school-libraries	BLAVITY.COM	Jahaura Michelle	2026-09-30	News	school district
Department Of Education Strips Title IX Protections From LGBTQ+ Students https://newsone.com/6873077/education-department-strips-title-ix/	NEWSONE.COM	Angela M. Bronner	2026-09-30	Civil Rights & Social Justice	department of education

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Trump Administration Could Limit Your Access To Federal Student Loans, If Your Degree Doesn't Earn Enough https://afrotech.com/trump-administration-could-limit-your-access-to-federal-student-loans-if-your-degree-doesnt-earn-enough	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-29	Education	department of education
OpenAI To Pause Development Of Some AI Models — Here's Why https://afrotech.com/openai-to-pause-development-of-some-of-its-ai-models	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-28	Technology	department of education
Nikole Hannah-Jones and her daughter to revisit the school choice debate in upcoming 'This American Life' conversation https://thegrio.com/2026/09/25/nikole-hannah-jones-daughter-this-american-life/	THEGRIO.COM	Bolarinwa Oladeji	2026-09-25	News	school choice
Angela Bassett Created A Space For Black Talent At Yale In 1979. Now, Her Son Is Helping Revive It For Gen Z Creatives https://afrotech.com/angela-bassett-son-slater-vance-revives-yale-space-black-creatives	AFROTECH.COM	Trey Mangum	2026-09-24	Education	black student

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Nikole Hannah-Jones' school choice for her daughter sparks a debate over Black parents, education and sacrifice https://thegrio.com/2026/09/21/nikole-hannah-jones-daughter-segregation-schools-reaction/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-09-21	Lifestyle	school choice
The First HBCU-Authorized Public Charter School Is Set To Welcome Students In Columbia, SC https://afrotech.com/first-hbcu-charter-school-opens-south-carolina-education-technology	AFROTECH.COM	ShaCamree Gowdy	2026-09-21	Education	historically black college charter school
'What type of person would do that?' D.C. mother sues over hot sauce incident involving autistic son https://thegrio.com/2026/09/17/dc-mother-sues-school-aide-autistic-son-hot-sauce/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-09-17	News	school district
NAACP CEO Derrick Johnson Slams the Protect College Sports Act https://www.theroot.com/naacp-ceo-derrick-johnson-slams-the-protect-college-spo-2000126325	THEROOT.COM	Rashad Grove	2026-09-16	Culture	black student

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Black father sues Massachusetts school district after son's suicide attempt, alleging years of racist bullying https://thegrio.com/2026/09/11/nauset-bullying-lawsuit-black-student/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-11	News	black student school district
Mamdani's New AI Policy: What Do We Have to Lose? https://www.ebony.com/mamdani-new-ai-policy-what-do-we-have-to-lose/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-09	Culture	achievement gap
Philadelphia charter school, former CEO agree to pay nearly \$4 million over alleged discrimination against Black applicants https://thegrio.com/2026/09/05/franklin-towne-settlement-black-applicants/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-05	News	charter school
Fayetteville State University Opens \$69.3M Building Featuring STEM Lab To Prepare Teachers For Innovation https://afrotech.com/fayetteville-state-university-opens-69-3m-building-featuring-stem-lab	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-04	Education	historically black college
Morgan State University Awarded \$3M From Baltimore Ravens Owner To Fund Scholarships https://afrotech.com/morgan-state-university-awarded-3m-in-scholarships-from-baltimore-ravens-owner	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-04	Education	historically black college

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
'We did not feel like we were going to make it out': Black students recount terrifying UNC campus attack https://thegrio.com/2026/09/02/unc-black-students-watch-party-attack-greenlaw/	THEGRIO.COM	Bolarinwa Oladeji	2026-09-02	News	black student

Policing & Public Safety

14 articles

Police reform, use of force, accountability, community safety, officer-involved shootings, qualified immunity

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Trump Immigration Court Deporting Unaccompanied Children As Young As 2 https://newsone.com/6873137/trump-immigration-court-deporting-children/	NEWSONE.COM	Zack Linly	2026-09-30	Civil Rights & Social Justice	immigration enforcement
Federal Judge Lifts Oakland Police Department's Consent Decree https://newsone.com/6873131/oakland-police-department-consent-decree-lifted/	NEWSONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-09-30	Civil Rights & Social Justice	excessive force police department consent decree excessive policing
DHS Uses NFL Legend's Image In Anti-Migrant Propaganda https://newsone.com/6873125/dhs-uses-nfl-legend-brian-dawkins-image/	NEWSONE.COM	Angela M. Bronner	2026-09-30	Nation	homeland security
After 23 years, Oakland police department exits federal oversight with accountability questions remaining https://thegrio.com/2026/09/30/oakland-police-oversight-ends-23-years/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-30	News	police department

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
A Right-Wing Sheriff In California Seized 650,000 Ballots, And The State's Ruling On It Could Impact Elections Nationwide https://blavity.com/california-ballot-seizing-ruling-could-impact-nationwide-elections	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-09-28	Politics	sheriff
Galveston Cop Who Fired 8 Shots At Unarmed Man Won't Face Charges https://newsone.com/6872875/cop-killed-randy-martin-galveston-no-charges/	NEWSONE.COM	Angela M. Bronner	2026-09-28	Civil Rights & Social Justice	police officer
California Sheriff Ordered To Return Over 600K Ballots https://newsone.com/6872827/california-sheriff-chad-bianco-ordered-return-ballots/	NEWSONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-09-26	Nation	sheriff
Polls: Betrayed by Trump, Latino Voters Are Ready To Hand Republicans the Ultimate Payback https://www.theroot.com/polls-betrayed-by-trump-latino-voters-are-ready-to-ha-2000127425	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-23	Culture	immigration enforcement
Jon Ossoff's 'Obama Swagger' Has TikTok in a Chokehold https://www.theroot.com/jon-ossoffs-obama-swagger-has-tiktok-in-a-chokehold-2000127323	THEROOT.COM	Mahalia Otshudy	2026-09-23	News	chokehold
Renee Good's mother says she voted for Trump before daughter was killed by ICE agent https://thegrio.com/2026/09/23/renee-good-mother-voted-trump-ice-shooting/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-09-23	Featured	ice agent

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
National Black Voter Day: What Black Voters Need to Know Before the Midterms https://www.theroot.com/national-black-voter-day-what-black-voters-need-to-know-2000126584	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-18	Culture	law enforcement
D4vd hit with wrongful death lawsuit from Celeste Rivas Hernandez's family https://thegrio.com/2026/09/09/d4vd-wrongful-death-lawsuit-celeste-rivas/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-09	News	wrongful death
Celeb Love Check: Phaedra Parks' Hard Launch, Ernest Harden Jr.'s Sweet Shoutout, 'Black Panther' Alum Weds? https://www.ebony.com/celeb-love-check-phaedra-parks-ernest-harden-jr-letitia-wright/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-08	Celebrity	chokehold
Family sues Aurora, Co., police officer over fatal shooting of Rajon Belt-Stubblefield https://thegrio.com/2026/09/02/rajon-belt-stubblefield-lawsuit-aurora-police/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-02	News	police officer

Voter Suppression

14 articles

Voting rights, ballot access restrictions, gerrymandering, election interference, disenfranchisement

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
From Ida B. Wells to Selma: The Ongoing Fight to Protect the Vote https://www.essence.com/news/politics/voting-rights-act-supreme-court-south-freedom-summer/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	Opinion	voting rights
New poll finds Black women voters are approaching the midterms with Obama-era enthusiasm, but a different motivation https://thegrio.com/2026/09/30/new-poll-finds-black-women-voters-are-approaching-the-midterms-with-obama-era-enthusiasm-but-a-different-motivation/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-30	Politics	voting rights
Black Women Are Sounding the Alarm About Voting Rights and America's Future https://capitalbnews.org/black-women-voters-poll-america-future/	CAPITALBNEWS.ORG	Aallyah Wright	2026-09-29		voting rights
James Talarico gets a warm welcome at HBCU classic as Black voter push enters final stretch https://thegrio.com/2026/09/28/james-talarico-black-voters-hbcu-state-fair-classic-prairie-view/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-28	Politics	black voter

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Texas Redistricting Effort Could Backfire On Republicans https://newsone.com/6872924/texas-redistricting-effort-could-backfire-republicans/	NEWSONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-09-28	Nation	redistricting
Trump DOJ Drops Dozens Of School Desegregation Cases, But The Most Segregated Schools Are In The North https://newsone.com/6872845/trump-doj-drops-school-desegregation-cases/	NEWSONE.COM	Angela M. Bronner	2026-09-27	Civil Rights & Social Justice	jim crow
California Sheriff Ordered To Return Over 600K Ballots https://newsone.com/6872827/california-sheriff-chad-bianco-ordered-return-ballots/	NEWSONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-09-26	Nation	election security
Black Voters in Kansas City Face Divided District as Federal Court Sides With GOP https://capitalbnews.org/missouri-redistricting-kansas-city-voters/	CAPITALBNEWS.ORG	Calvin Davis, Alecia Taylor	2026-09-22		redistricting
National Black Voter Day: What Black Voters Need to Know Before the Midterms https://www.theroot.com/national-black-voter-day-what-black-voters-need-to-kno-2000126584	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-18	Culture	redistricting black voter

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Here are the Voter Registration Deadlines in Every State https://www.ebony.com/voter-registration-deadlines-every-us-state/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-16	News & Politics	voter registration
CBC Institute launches multimillion-dollar Black voter campaign as leaders call out Democratic Party failures https://thegrio.com/2026/09/15/cbc-institute-black-voter-campaign-democratic-party-failures/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-15	Politics	black voter
National Voter Registration Day: Why Black voters are being urged to check their registration https://thegrio.com/2026/09/15/national-voter-registration-day-black-voters/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-15	Politics	voter registration redistricting
ACLU Expert Warns: South Carolina Voter Purge is Disproportionately Targeting People of Color https://www.theroot.com/aclu-expert-warns-south-carolina-voter-purge-is-dispro-2000124448	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-04	Culture	voter purge voter rolls

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
MLK's Granddaughter Yolanda Calls To 'Restore The Dream' At New Voting Rights March On Washington https://blavity.com/mlks-granddaughter-yolanda-calls-to-restore-the-dream	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-09-01	Politics	voting rights

Maternal Health

10 articles

Black maternal mortality, obstetric racism, prenatal care disparities, childbirth outcomes

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
The Latest Twist in the McKenna West Surrogacy Battle: Texas Court Clears Baby for California Transfer https://www.theroot.com/the-latest-twist-in-the-mckenna-west-surrogacy-battle-2000127073	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-22	Black Maternal Healthcare	black maternal
Kamala Harris campaigns with Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan, focusing on Black maternal health https://thegrio.com/2026/09/22/kamala-harris-abdul-el-sayed-michigan-black-maternal-health/	THEGRIO.COM	Peter Kerich	2026-09-22	Featured	maternal health black maternal
Keke Palmer on being 'forever postpartum' and the mom community helping her navigate motherhood https://thegrio.com/2026/09/21/keke-palmer-on-being-forever-postpartum-and-the-mom-community-helping-her-navigate-motherhood/	THEGRIO.COM	Haniyah P.	2026-09-21	Lifestyle	postpartum

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Exclusive: Planned Parenthood's CEO Explains What's At Stake For Black Maternal Health in the Midterms https://www.theroot.com/exclusive-planned-parenthoods-ceo-explains-whats-at-st-2000126741	THEROOT.COM	Amber Ferguson	2026-09-19	Black Maternal Healthcare	maternal health black maternal
Family Lawsuit Blames Texas Abortion Restrictions for Mother's Tragic Death https://www.theroot.com/family-lawsuit-blames-texas-abortion-restrictions-for-m-2000126415	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-17	Black Maternal Healthcare	maternal health black maternal pregnancy care
McKenna West Takes Custody Battle to the Supreme Court https://www.theroot.com/mckenna-west-takes-custody-battle-to-the-supreme-court-2000126345	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-16	Black Maternal Healthcare	black maternal
This Security Guard-Turned-Doula is Helping Black Moms Feel Safe https://www.theroot.com/this-security-guard-turned-doula-is-helping-black-moms-2000126317	THEROOT.COM	Shellie M. Scott	2026-09-16	Health	maternal health maternal care doula
After Losing Her Son, Monique Rodriguez is Putting \$2 Million Behind Better Birth Care for Black Women https://www.theroot.com/after-losing-her-son-monique-rodriguez-is-putting-2-m-2000125186	THEROOT.COM	Amber Ferguson	2026-09-10	Black Maternal Healthcare	maternal health black maternal
As Lindsay Clancy's Case Ends in Mistrial, this Black Mother Gets a Second Chance https://www.theroot.com/as-lindsay-clancy-s-case-ends-in-mistrial-this-black-m-2000124546	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-04	Black Maternal Healthcare	black maternal

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Could This Black Mother's Tragic Case Predict the Fate of Lindsay Clancy's Postpartum Psychosis Defense? https://www.theroot.com/could-this-black-mothers-tragic-case-predict-the-fate-o-2000123827	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-08-31	Crime	postpartum

Book Bans & Anti-DEI

9 articles

Censorship of Black literature, DEI rollbacks, critical race theory bans, curriculum restrictions

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
'A Lot Of Black People Are Wondering, What Are We Getting For Our Loyalty?' ESSENCE Black Futures Now Honorees Speak Candidly About The Upcoming Election - Esse https://www.essence.com/video/black-history-month-black-futures-now-voter-panel-davis-ferrell-zabala/	ESSENCE.COM	https://www.facebook.com/essence	nan	Video	black history month

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Ex-NAACP president Cornell William Brooks challenges ‘Project 2025’ architect in heated debate over DEI https://thegrio.com/2026/09/28/cornell-brooks-kevin-roberts-debate-dei-project-2025/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-09-28	Politics	dei
More Than 50 Years After Its Release, Why School Districts Keep Toni Morrison’s ‘The Bluest Eye’ On Their Book Ban Lists https://www.theroot.com/more-than-50-years-after-its-release-why-school-districts-keep-toni-morrison-2000127645	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-24	Culture	book ban
UT Austin Eliminates African American, Latino And Gender Studies Majors After Trump Admin Pressure https://blavity.com/ut-austin-eliminates-african-american-latino-and-gender-studies-majors-trump-pressure	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-09-21	Politics	ethnic studies

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Accenture Settles With Justice Department For \$25M Over DEI Allegations https://afrotech.com/accenture-settles-with-justice-department-for-25m-over-dei-allegations	AFROTECH.COM	Samantha Dorisca	2026-09-17	Technology	dei
EMERGE!'s 15th Anniversary Show Was a Celebration of Black Creativity, From Karl Kani to Danessa Myricks https://www.ebony.com/emerges-15th-anniversary-show-was-a-celebration-of-black-creativity-from-karl-kani-to-danessa-myricks/	EBONY.COM	—	2026-09-17	Fashion	dei
The Slow Disappearance of Black Studies on College Campuses https://capitalbnews.org/black-studies-programs-college-cuts/	CAPITALBNEWS.ORG	Alecia Taylor	2026-09-15		dei

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
How New Federal Rules Could Impact Private Colleges' DEI Programs https://www.theroot.com/how-new-federal-rules-could-impact-private-colleges-dei-2000124463	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-04	News	dei
Deloitte To Pay \$21.5M To Settle Lawsuit As Trump Administration Continues Push To Dismantle DEI https://afrotech.com/deloitte-trump-administration-lawsuit-settlement-diversity-equity-inclusion	AFROTECH.COM	ShaCamree Gowdy	2026-09-01	Business	dei

Reparations

9 articles

Reparations for slavery, community investment, wealth redistribution, descendants of enslaved people

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
A Country's Unpaid Debt https://www.essence.com/news/a-countrys-unpaid-debt-ss-2026/	ESSENCE.COM	Shelby Stewart	nan	Money & Career	reparations

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Quaker Congregation Helps Black Families Purchase Homes As Part Of Its Reparations Program https://blavity.com/quaker-congregation-helps-black-families-purchase-homes	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-09-30	News	reparations reparations program
The Quaker Reparations That Helped This Black Philly Family Build Generational Wealth https://www.theroot.com/the-quaker-reparations-that-helped-this-black-philly-family-build-generational-wealth-2000126454	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-29	Culture	reparations
Trump Admin Aims To Block An Illinois City From Giving Reparations To Black Residents https://blavity.com/trump-admin-aims-to-block-city-from-giving-reparations	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-09-18	Politics	reparations
In LA, Some Black Residents May Soon Receive Environmental Reparations https://capitalbnews.org/california-oil-wells-reparations/	CAPITALBNEWS.ORG	Adam Mahoney	2026-09-16		reparations

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
The Trump Administration Makes Its Case Against Evanston's Reparations Program https://www.theroot.com/the-trump-administration-makes-its-case-against-evansto-2000126068	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-15	Culture	reparations evanston reparations reparations program
In moment of atonement, Cam Newton issues public apology to Black women: 'Trying to rehabilitate my relationship' https://thegrio.com/2026/09/14/cam-newton-black-women-apology/	THEGRIO.COM	Brandon Caldwell	2026-09-14	Lifestyle	atonement
Jamaica asks King Charles III to put Britain's slavery reparations obligations to a legal test https://thegrio.com/2026/09/09/jamaica-reparations-petition-king-charles/	THEGRIO.COM	Odafe Oghen	2026-09-09	News	reparations
Jamaica Takes Push for Reparations Straight to King Charles III https://www.theroot.com/jamaica-takes-push-for-reparations-straight-to-king-cha-2000124909	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-08	Culture	reparations

■ Housing & Displacement

4 articles

Affordable housing, eviction crisis, gentrification, homelessness, housing discrimination

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Mamdani Celebrates Milestone As NYC Hits 200K Pothole Repairs, Sees Drop In Murders And More Affordable Housing https://blavity.com/mamdani-pothole-repairs-milestone	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-09-22	Politics	affordable housing
The First HBCU-Authorized Public Charter School Is Set To Welcome Students In Columbia, SC https://afrotech.com/first-hbcu-charter-school-opens-south-carolina-education-technology	AFROTECH.COM	ShaCamree Gowdy	2026-09-21	Education	zoning
New York's 'Furniture Queen' is Keeping Tons of Goods Out of Landfills—and Giving Them to People in Need https://www.theroot.com/new-yorks-furniture-queen-is-keeping-tons-of-goods-out-2000126645	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-09-18	Culture	public housing
Why Thousands of Affordable Housing Units Sit Vacant While Millions Remain Unhoused https://www.theroot.com/why-thousands-of-affordable-housing-units-sit-vacant-wh-2000124966	THEROOT.COM	Angela Wilson	2026-09-08	Culture	affordable housing homelessness

■ Environmental Justice

4 articles

Environmental racism, pollution in Black communities, climate vulnerability, toxic exposure

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
Federal Court Rules Clean Water Not A Constitutional Right In Jackson, Mississippi Case https://blavity.com/federal-court-rules-clean-water-not-a-constitutional-right-in-jackson-mississippi-case	BLAVITY.COM	Christopher Rhodes	2026-09-10	Politics	clean water
Africa’s Richest Man Aliko Dangote Takes His Energy Empire Public With \$1.6B IPO https://afrotech.com/aliko-dangote-ipo	AFROTECH.COM	Tyler-Christian Daniels	2026-09-09	News	refinery
Court says clean water isn’t a constitutional right. Leaders say majority-Black Jackson, Miss., deserves better https://thegrio.com/2026/09/09/jackson-clean-drinking-water-isnt-a-constitutional-right/	THEGRIO.COM	Gerren Keith Gaynor	2026-09-09	Politics	clean water
When Clean Water Isn’t a Constitutional Right, Black Communities Pay the Price https://www.theroot.com/when-clean-water-isn-t-a-constitutional-right-black-co-2000124898	THEROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-08	Culture	environmental justice clean water

Criminal Justice Reform

3 articles

Mass incarceration, sentencing disparities, prison conditions, bail reform, reentry programs

TITLE & URL	PUBLICATION	AUTHOR	DATE	CATEGORY	MATCHED PHRASES
After 41 Years Behind Bars, Death Row Inmate Finally Gets a Chance at Freedom https://www.theroot.com/after-41-years-behind-bars-death-row-inmate-finally-ge-2000128437	THE ROOT.COM	Phenix S Halley	2026-09-30	Crime	death row
Black Man Released From Death Row After Crime Scene DNA Doesn't Match Him https://newsone.com/6873006/douglas-stewart-carter-released-dna-evidence/	NEWS ONE.COM	Joe Jurado	2026-09-29	Civil Rights & Social Justice	death row
D4vd Fires Legal Team, Switches To Public Defender In Celeste Rivas Hernandez Murder Case https://blavity.com/d4vd-fires-legal-team-switches-to-public-defender	BLAVITY.COM	Tomas Kassahun	2026-09-01	News	public defender

SECTION 08

Topic Word Clouds

Visual frequency maps of headline language in articles matched to each topic. Term size reflects relative frequency across matched article titles.

trump black police stevenson

department family nationwide elections unaccompanied sheriff decree accountability anti court consent children lifts right dhs 600k t polls propaganda wing unarmed nfl years ruling california shots ordered face immigration image state questions impact cop won seized man latino ballots uses exits charges legend return betrayed fired remaining deporting young judge oakland federal

[illegible]

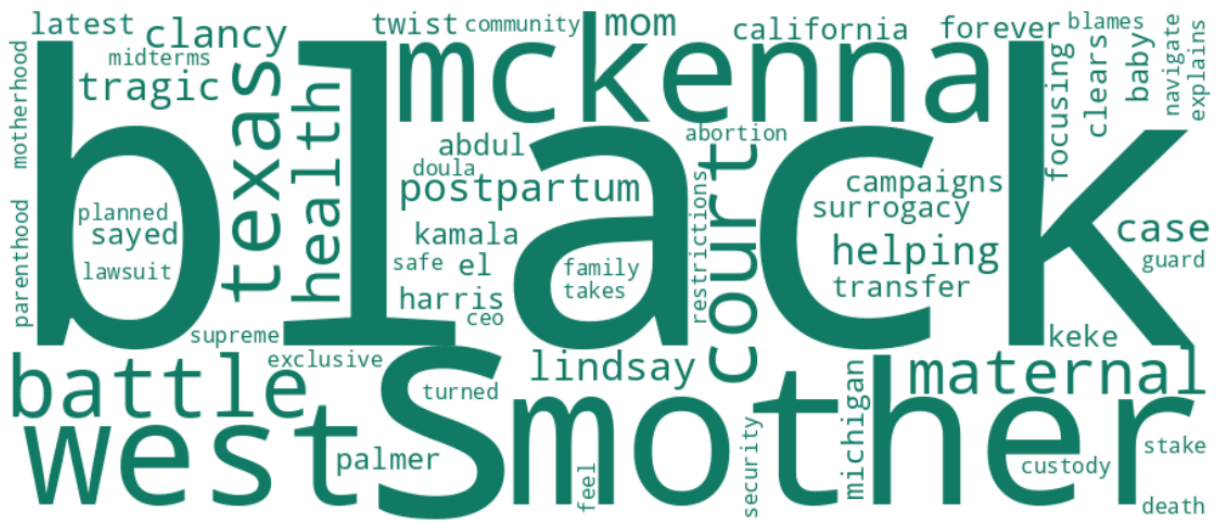
Voter Suppression

A word cloud of terms related to the Black Lives Matter movement. The most prominent words are 'black' and 'lives', which are the largest and most central. Other large words include 'settles', 'trump', 'studies', 'essences', 'challenges', 'william', 'maiors', 'book', 'years', 'lists', 'toni', 'justice', 'debate', 'districts', 'department', 'creativity', 'disappearance', '15th', 'myricks', 'slow', 'emerge', 'allegations', 'gender', 'pressure', 'anniversary', 'austin', 'keep', 'campuses', 'heated', 'cornell', 'project', 'release', 'naacp', 'karl', 'celebration', '25m', 'morrison', 'brook', 'bluest', 'school', 'american', 'ut', 'ban', 'accents', 'eye', 'latino', 'new', 'kani', 'show', 'admin', 'architect', 'department', 'creativity', 'disappearance', '15th', 'myricks', 'slow', 'emerge', 'allegations', 'gender', 'pressure', 'anniversary', 'austin', 'keep', 'campuses', 'heated', 'cornell', 'project', 'release', 'naacp', 'karl', 'celebration', '25m', 'morrison', 'brook', 'bluest', 'school', 'american', 'ut', 'ban', 'accents', 'eye', 'latino', 'new', 'kani', 'show', 'admin', 'architect', 'department', 'creativity', 'disappearance', '15th', 'myricks', 'slow', 'emerge', 'allegations', 'gender', 'pressure', 'anniversary', 'austin', 'keep', 'campuses', 'heated', 'cornell', 'project', 'release', 'naacp', 'karl', 'celebration', '25m'. The words are in various shades of brown and orange, and are arranged in a way that they overlap and flow together, creating a sense of movement and energy. The background is a solid dark brown color.

[illegible]

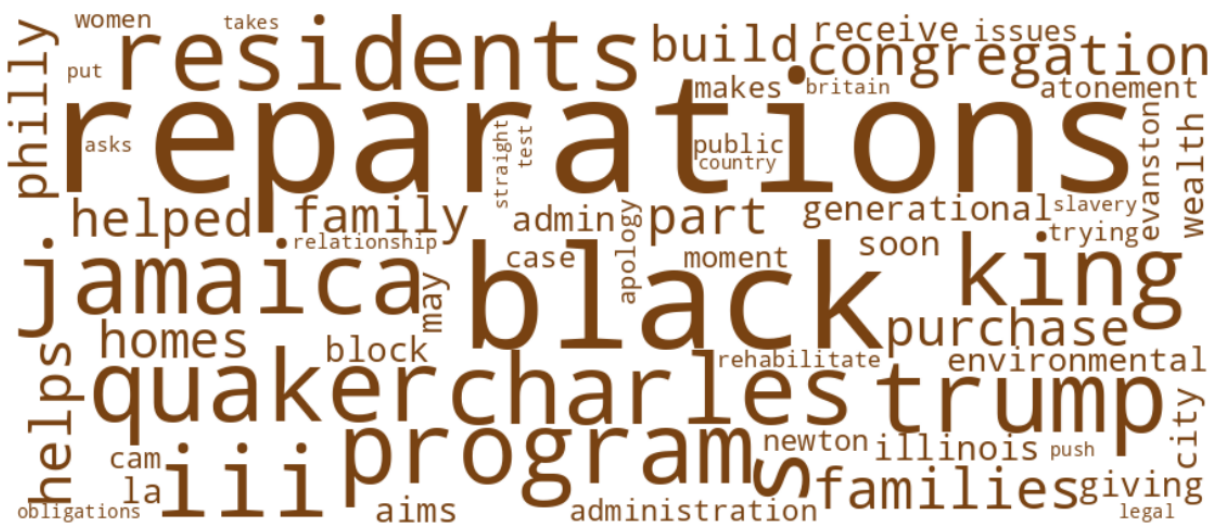
Housing & Displacement

Key Terms: Maternal Health



Maternal Health

Key Terms: Reparations



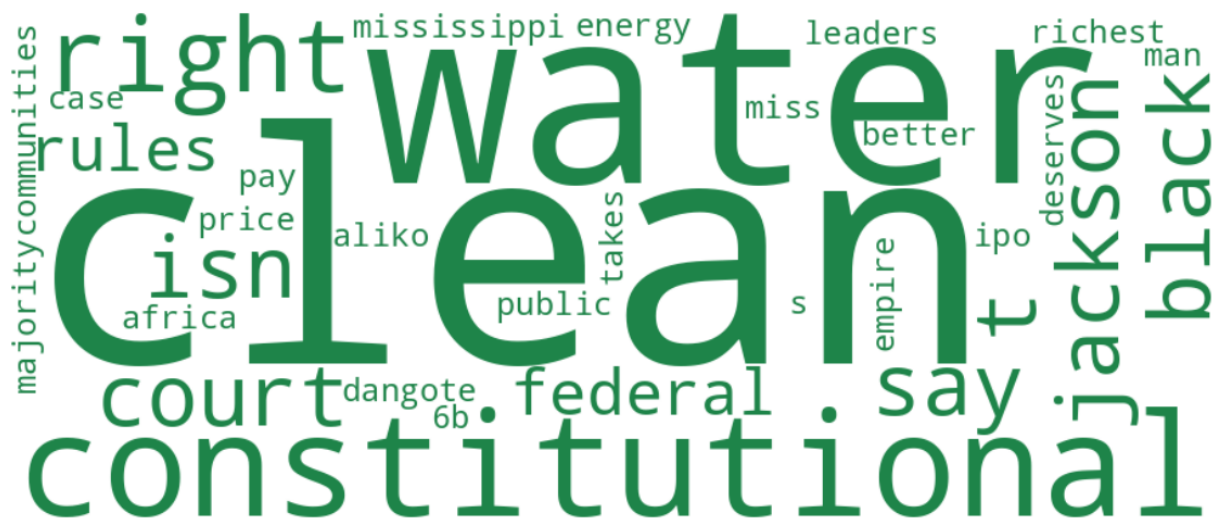
Reparations

[illegible]

A word cloud of terms related to the case of George Jackson. The most prominent words are 'death row' and 'years', which are the largest and most central. Other large words include 'behind bars', 'freedom', 'released', 'fires', 'scene', 'doesn't', 'match', 't', 'man', 'chance', 'gets', 'legal', 'dna', 'd4vd', 'case', 'inmate', 'defender', 'switches', 'team', 'crime', 'murder', 'black', 'hernandez', 'celeste', 'public', 'rivas', and 'man'. The words are arranged in a dense, overlapping manner, with some words appearing in different orientations.

Criminal Justice Reform

Key Terms: Environmental Justice



Environmental Justice

Key Terms: Economic Equity & Wealth Gap



Economic Equity & Wealth Gap

SECTION 09

Methodology

Data collection, analysis approach, and known limitations.

Data Collection. Articles were scraped from 7 Black media publications (The Grio, The Root, NewsOne, Capital B News, Blavity, Essence, Ebony) using RSS feeds as the primary method and HTML scraping as a fallback. Only articles with a publication date within the 30-day window ending **October 01, 2026** were included. Each article record captures: title, snippet/description, publication, date, category, and URL.

Topic Matching. Each article's title, description, and category were matched against a curated dictionary of 12 social conflict topics. Each topic contains 20–35 seed phrases. Matching uses whole-word regular expression search (case-insensitive) with optional suffix flexibility (plurals, verb forms). Articles can match multiple topics simultaneously.

TF-IDF Keyword Extraction. Term Frequency–Inverse Document Frequency (TF-IDF) scoring was applied to the full corpus using scikit-learn's `TfidfVectorizer` (n-grams 1–3, min_df=2, max_df=0.85, sublinear TF normalization). Scores represent a term's relative prominence in this period compared to its overall distribution across the corpus.

Limitations. (1) Topic matching is constrained by the seed phrase dictionary — articles using different terminology for the same issue may not be captured. (2) RSS feed snippets vary in length and completeness by publication; full article body text is not analyzed. (3) The 30-day rolling window does not capture longer-term trends. (4) Coverage rates reflect the share of articles that explicitly reference tracked topics, not the total editorial attention given to those topics.

Tracked Topics (12). Policing & Public Safety · Voter Suppression · Book Bans & Anti-DEI · Housing & Displacement · Maternal Health · Redlining & Fair Housing · Anti-Black Surveillance · Reparations · School Funding · Criminal Justice Reform · Environmental Justice · Economic Equity & Wealth Gap.